SAILPOINT IDENTITYNOW ARCHITECTURE

Building Access in IdentityNow

Identity Model Components and Access Model

A comprehensive architectural blueprint detailing identity generation, profile configuration, account correlation, access modeling, role engineering, and dynamic lifecycle governance.



PRESENTER
Enterprise IAM Architecture Team

DATE
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SERIES
SailPoint IdentityNow Architecture

CORE ENTITIES

Identity Model Components

The fundamental building blocks governing digital persona and target system permissions

WHO YOU ARE

Identity

A centralized digital representation of a person or service account and all associated attributes, security context, and organizational status. An identity is a governance construct; users never log into target systems directly as identities.

WHERE YOU EXIST

Account

A representation of an identity on a specific source system (e.g., Active Directory, SAP, Salesforce, AWS). Accounts hold system-level credentials, native identifiers, and raw source attributes.

WHAT YOU CAN DO

Access

Securities and permissions that grant accounts the ability to perform actions within a source system. Defined natively as entitlements, authorizations, or groups, and packaged through access profiles and business roles.

INGESTION PIPELINE

Reading from Leading HR Sources

Differentiating Authoritative Systems of Record from Connected Target Applications

SYSTEMS OF RECORD

Authoritative Sources (HR)

Core enterprise HR platforms (Workday, SAP HR, SuccessFactors) serve as the single source of truth for employment status and personnel attributes, triggering identity generation.

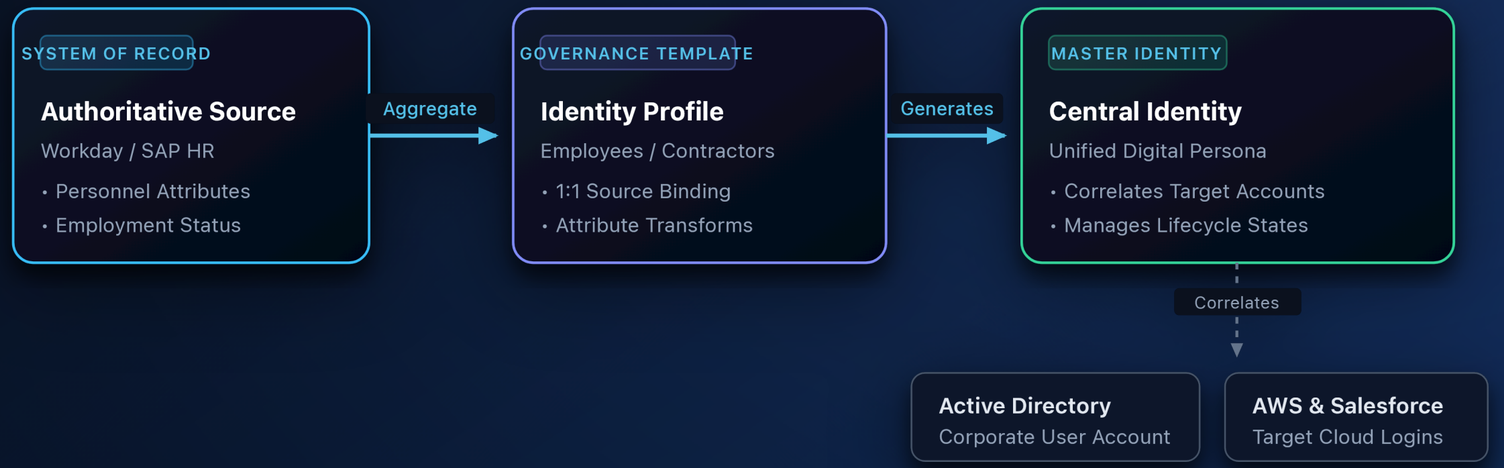
OPERATIONAL REPOSITORIES

Target Application Sources

Secondary systems (Active Directory, LDAP, AWS, Salesforce) where users hold accounts. Aggregating target sources attaches accounts to existing identities via correlation.

Authoritative Ingestion Architecture

SOURCE LINEAGE



ADMIN WORKFLOW

Building Identities: Step-by-Step Workflow

Administrative configuration sequence to establish authoritative ingestion

ADMIN > CONNECTIONS > SOURCES

1. Create Authoritative Source

Navigate to Admin > Connections > Sources > +New. Select the appropriate connector type (e.g., Workday, Flat File, Active Directory), configure host connectivity, and test connection credentials.

ADMIN > IDENTITIES > PROFILES

2. Create Identity Profile

Navigate to Admin > Identities > Identity Profiles > +New. Create a named profile (e.g., 'Corporate Employees'), associate it directly with the authoritative source created in Step 1, and set profile priority.

MAPPINGS & TRANSFORMS

3. Configure Identity Mappings

Map raw source attributes to IdentityNow standard identity attributes (Name, Email, Department, Job Title, Manager). Apply transform logic for complex naming and organizational data normalization.

SOURCES > IMPORT DATA

4. Aggregate Source Accounts

Navigate to Admin > Connections > Sources > Import Data tab > Import Accounts. Aggregation ingests account records, executes attribute transforms, and automatically generates master identities.

GOVERNANCE TEMPLATES

Identity Profiles: Templates & Priority

Defining identity creation templates, attribute policies, and precedence resolution

TYPE ALIGNMENT

Identity Template Scope

An Identity Profile is a template for creating identities and enforcing governance policy. Profiles are typically aligned to identity types: Employees, Contractors, Students, Faculty, Partners, or Service Accounts.

ARCHITECTURAL AXIOM

Single Profile Assignment Rule

An identity can only be managed by a single Identity Profile at any given time. An individual who moves between types is transitioned cleanly rather than linked to multiple concurrent profiles.

PRECEDENCE ENGINE

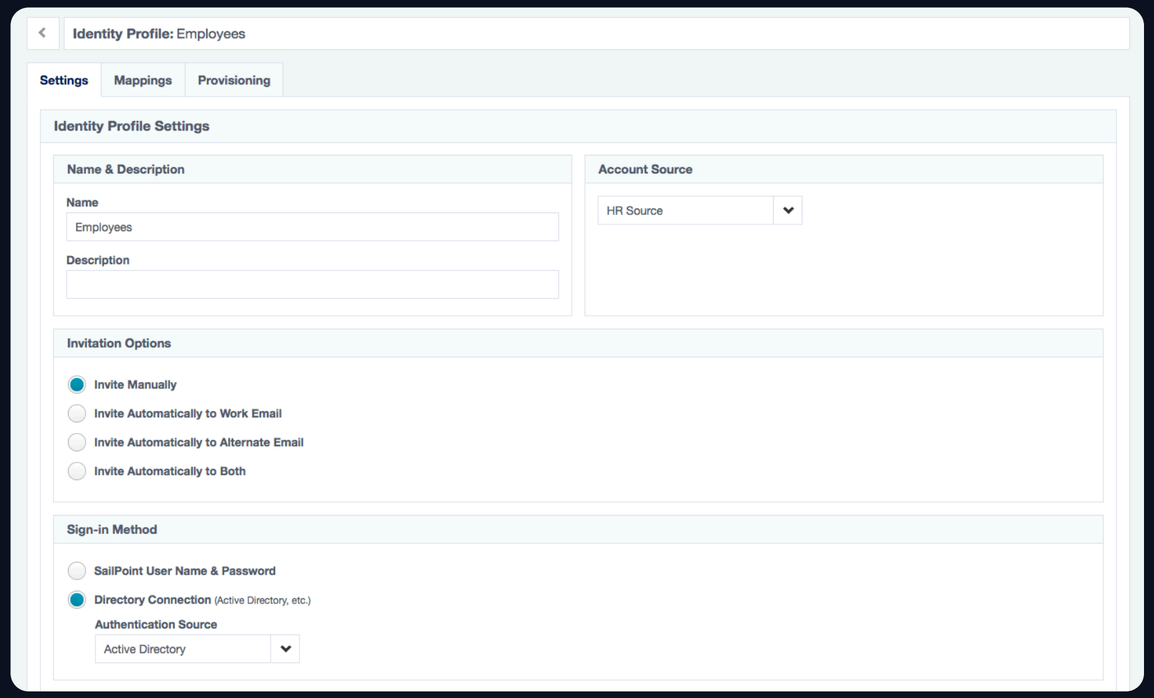
Deterministic Priority Hierarchy

Implicit priority ordering in the administrative UI dictates evaluation order. If an account candidate matches multiple profiles, the highest priority profile wins. Priority can also be adjusted via REST API.

SECURITY POLICY

Identity Profile Settings & Auth Controls

Configuring account sources, authentication providers, and perimeter safeguards



IdentityNow Console: Identity Profile Settings Configuration

SOURCE ASSOCIATION

Account Source Specification

Defines the authoritative system of record linked to this profile (e.g., 'HR Source'). Establishes identity attribute origin.

AUTHENTICATION

Sign-in Method & Directory Auth

Specifies authentication method: Directory Connection (Active Directory), IdentityNow native credentials, or federated SAML SSO.

PERIMETER SAFEGUARDS

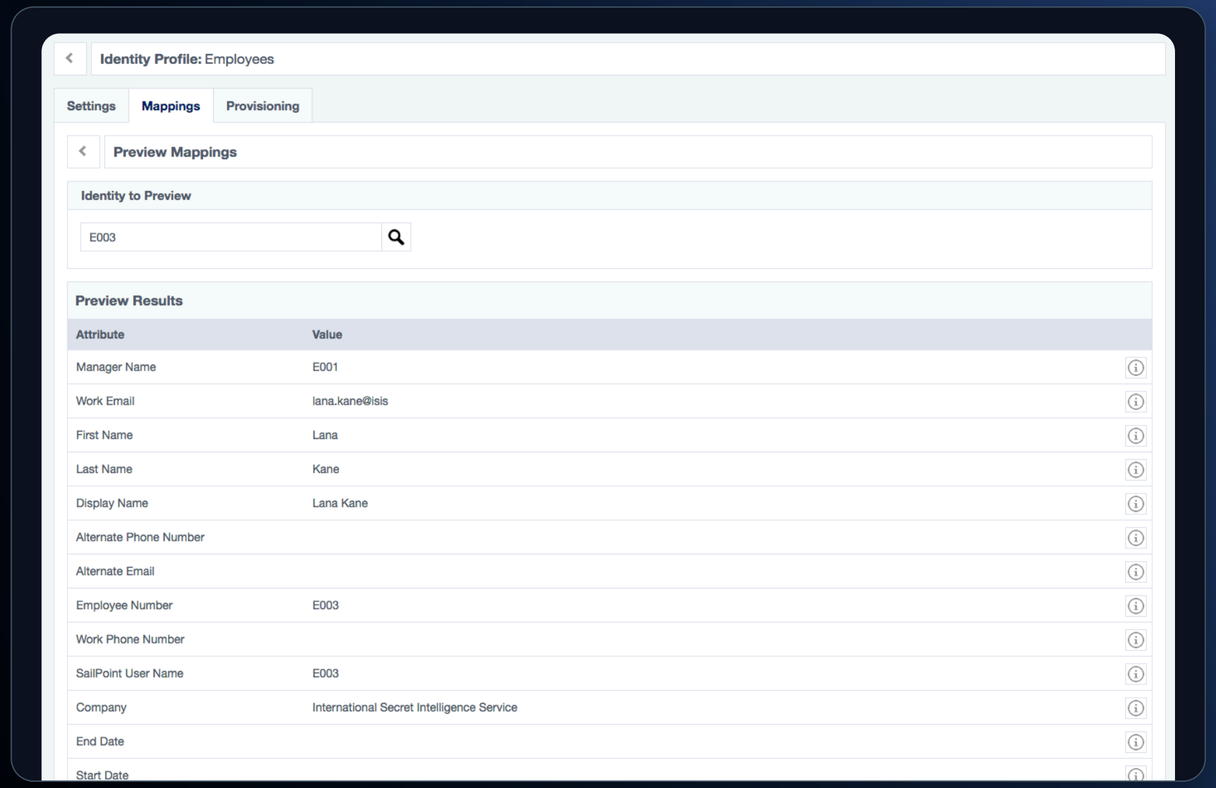
Invitation & Perimeter Policy

Controls manual/automated work email invitations, off-network authentication boundaries, untrusted geo-fencing, and MFA triggers.

DATA TRANSFORMATION

Identity Profile Mappings & Preview Testing

Normalizing raw source attributes and validating transform logic prior to rollout



SIMULATION ENGINE

Transform Testing in Preview

Allows administrators to simulate attribute mapping and transform results (UPN generation, display name calculation) without committing data.

PRE-REQUISITE

Requires Aggregated Data

Preview testing requires aggregated account records from the authoritative source to execute attribute logic against real values.

TRANSFORMS

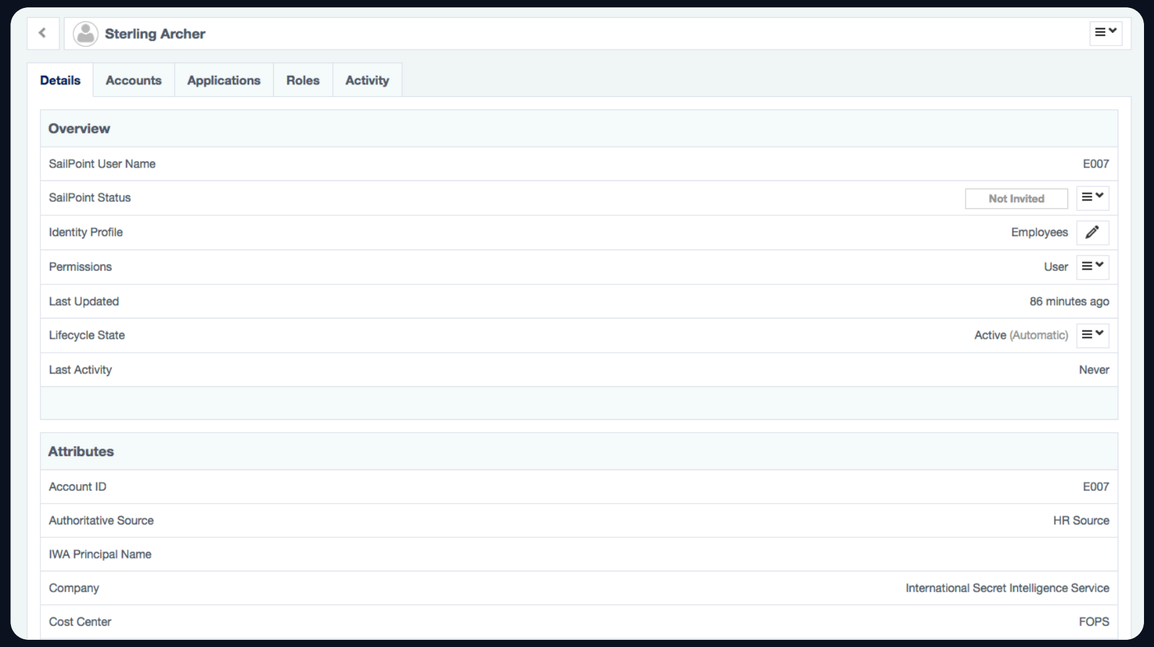
Attribute Normalization

Enforces date formatting, substring operations, phone number standardization, and multi-field concatenation.

ADMINISTRATIVE VIEW

Administrative View of an Identity

Comprehensive inspection interface for identity governance, lineage, and operational state



Identity Profile Console: Administrative Inspection View

CORE PROFILE

Identity Details

Displays master identity attributes, email, employment type, organizational department, assigned manager, current lifecycle state, and profile ownership.

CONNECTED INVENTORY

Account Details

Lists all correlated target system accounts (Active Directory, SAP, AWS, Salesforce) with native identifiers, account status, and sync state.

EFFECTIVE PERMISSIONS

Access Details

Complete inventory of all effective access: assigned business roles, technical access profiles, and individual entitlements with granting provenance.

IDENTITY VISIBILITY

Search View vs. Public View of an Identity

Contrasting enterprise compliance querying with organizational self-service visibility

ENTERPRISE DISCOVERY & AUDIT

Search & Audit View (Slide 12)

- Query-Driven: Fast, multi-attribute elastic search across the entire identity inventory.
- Deep Correlation: Inspects accounts, entitlement assignments, and access profiles across disconnected systems simultaneously.
- Audit & Compliance: Generates point-in-time compliance snapshots, policy violation tracking, and historical access certifications.
- Operational Analytics: Allows administrators to filter by role membership, certification status, or lifecycle anomalies.

ENTERPRISE COLLABORATION

Public Directory View (Slide 13)

- Peer-to-Peer Directory: Clean organizational profile accessible to all enterprise users.
- Public Identity Attributes: Exposes business-appropriate attributes such as job title, department, office location, email, and phone.
- Managerial Lineage: Displays the organizational hierarchy chart, direct reports, and management chain.
- Privacy Safeguards: Strictly conceals privileged security attributes, system identifiers, and raw account credentials.

CORRELATION ENGINE

Target Account Aggregation & Identity Correlation

Establishing ownership links between disparate target accounts and central identities

DETERMINISTIC MATCHING

Correlation Rules

Matches target account attributes to master identity properties (e.g. account.mail == identity.email or employeeNumber == id) to establish ownership.

ORPHAN ISOLATION

Uncorrelated Account Queue

Accounts with no matching identity or conflicting multi-identity matches are quarantined for administrative review, preventing unmanaged shadow accounts.



ACCESS HIERARCHY

Access Model Components: The Hierarchy

Layered abstraction decoupling target system mechanics from business access policies

TECHNICAL LAYER (ATOMIC)

Entitlements

Direct system access rights, including group memberships or access permissions, granted to an account on a related source. Highly granular, system-specific, and low-level.

FUNCTIONAL LAYER (SINGLE-SOURCE)

Access Profiles

One or more entitlements from a single source system bundled and assigned as one cohesive operational unit (e.g., 'Active Directory Standard User' or 'Salesforce Support Agent').

BUSINESS LAYER (MULTI-SOURCE)

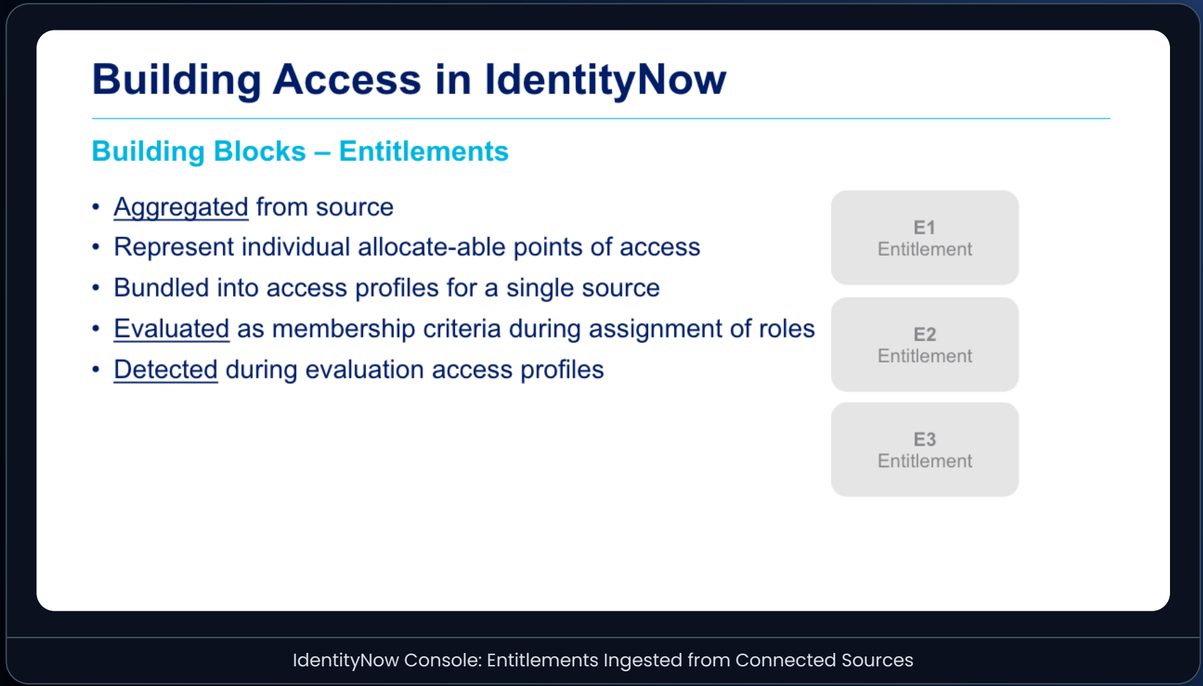
Roles

Cross-system governance packages that combine multiple Access Profiles across disparate sources aligned to business personas, organizational titles, or job functions.

ENTITLEMENT DISCOVERY

Reading Entitlements from Connected Sources

Discovering fine-grained security rights, group memberships, and system permissions



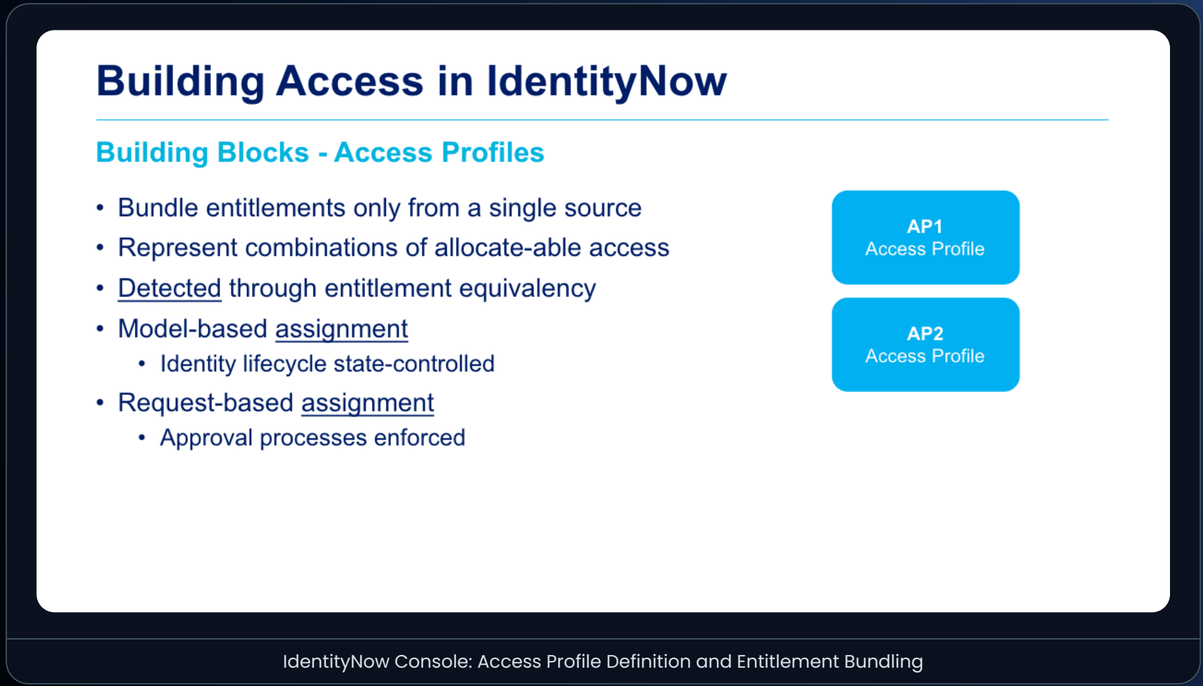
IdentityNow Console: Entitlements Ingested from Connected Sources

- Access Rights: Entitlements represent fine-grained security permissions, access levels, roles, or group memberships on a connected source.
- Account Binding: Entitlements are directly granted to accounts that exist on the source system.
- Discovery Process: Ingested during account aggregation or dedicated entitlement aggregation jobs (e.g., reading Active Directory security groups).
- Necessity of Abstraction: Managing thousands of raw system strings directly creates governance chaos; they must be encapsulated into Access Profiles.

ACCESS PROFILES

Access Profiles: Single-Source Bundles

Encapsulating atomic permissions into requestable, reconcilable governance units



IdentityNow Console: Access Profile Definition and Entitlement Bundling

ARCHITECTURAL AXIOM

Strict Single-Source Rule

One or more entitlements from a single source system (application) bundled and assigned as one unit. Access Profiles can NEVER span multiple sources.

SELF-SERVICE CATALOG

Request Center & Approvals

Users can request Access Profiles directly through the Request Center, governed by configurable multi-tiered approval workflows.

CONTINUOUS RECONCILIATION

Automated Detection Engine

Compares aggregated account entitlements against profile definitions. If an identity holds all member entitlements, IdentityNow detects and marks the profile as active.

ROLE ARCHITECTURE

Role Concept: Business Roles vs. Technical Roles

Translating business organizational structure into automated cross-application access

PERSONA & ORGANIZATIONAL

Business Roles (Slide 22)

- Aligned to Organizational Dimensions: Driven by OrgUnit, Job Role, Department, Location, or User Type.
- Cross-Application Packaging: Bundles multiple Access Profiles across diverse sources (e.g., Active Directory + Salesforce + Workday portal).
- Automated Assignment: Evaluated through membership matching criteria for zero-touch birthright provisioning without manual approval.
- Autonomous Lifecycle: Recalculates dynamically when identity attributes change, granting new access and revoking obsolete privileges.

SYSTEM & APPLICATION

Technical Roles & Containers (Slide 22)

- Application Container: Combines multiple Access Profiles or entitlements within a specific technical ecosystem to structure access.
- Technical Specialization: Encapsulates elevated or functional system roles (e.g., 'Oracle Financials DBA' or 'Active Directory Server Admin').
- Discretionary & Requestable: Published to the Request Center with mandatory managerial and application owner approvals.
- Separation of Duty (SoD): Enforces toxic combination checks to prevent conflicting technical access accumulation.

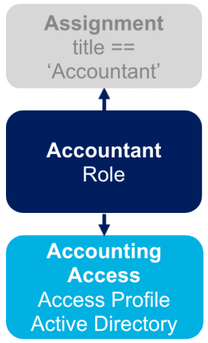
ROLE ASSIGNMENT

Role Membership Criteria & Assignment Mechanics

Configuring attribute rules, entitlement criteria, and provisioning triggers

Roles

- Business name and description
  - Describe the purpose of the role in business friendly context
- Membership (Assignment) based on criteria
  - Standard match of entitlement, identity or account attribute
    - Entitlement (e.g. AD Group = ‘Accountant’)
    - Attribute (e.g. title = ‘Accountant’)
  - Identity List - List of identities
  - Custom - Complex Rule
- Membership based on request
- Access can be 1+ Access Profile(s)
- Roles can be enabled or disabled
  - Only enabled roles will be assigned



IdentityNow Console: Role Membership Criteria and Matching Rules

IDENTITY ATTRIBUTE MATCHING

Attribute-Based Criteria

Identities are assigned to a role if they meet defined membership criteria (e.g., department == 'Finance' and location == 'Austin'). Assignment is fully automated.

ACCESS MATCHING

Entitlement-Based Criteria

You may use entitlements as membership criteria to assign roles. If an identity possesses specific source entitlements, IdentityNow attaches the role.

ZERO-TOUCH DELIVERY

Autonomous Provisioning

Once a role is assigned via membership criteria, IdentityNow automatically provisions all included Access Profiles without requiring approval tickets.

LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION

Lifecycle States & Dynamic Access Transitions

Synchronizing authoritative HR state changes with birthright access and revocation

DEFINED IN IDENTITY PROFILES

State-Driven Access Profile Grants

Moving into a lifecycle state (e.g., Active) directly grants 1-to-N baseline Access Profiles (e.g., corporate email, VPN, intranet access).

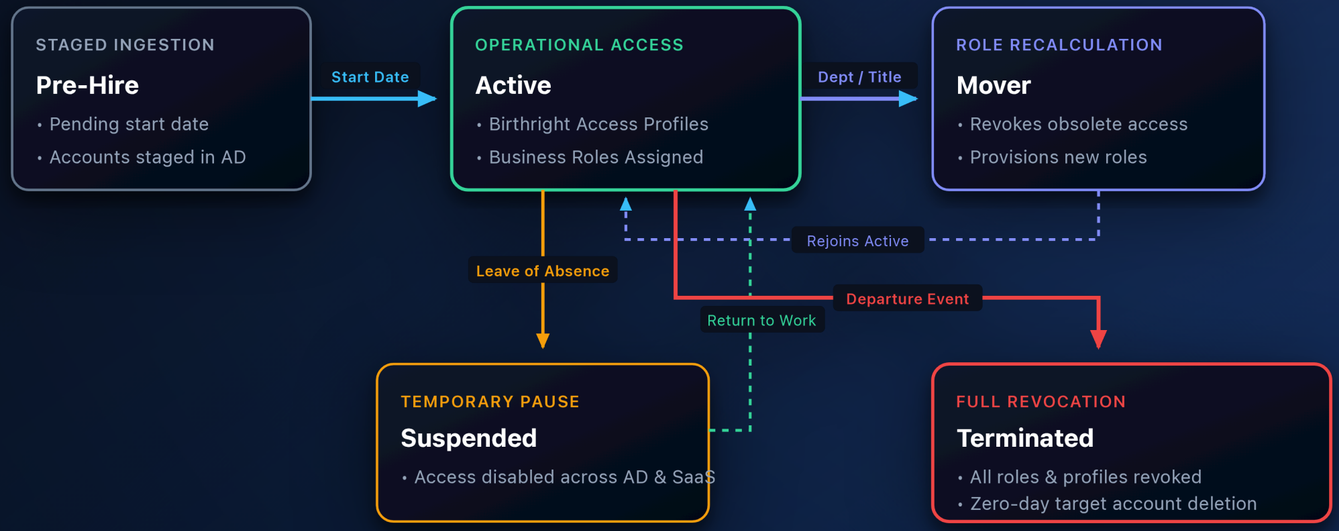
ZERO-DAY RESPONSE

Joiner-Mover-Leaver Automation

Attribute changes re-evaluate role criteria immediately, stripping obsolete privileges and provisioning new tools. Termination triggers instantaneous revocation across all sources.

Dynamic Lifecycle State Machine

JML AUTOMATION



ARCHITECTURE BLUEPRINT

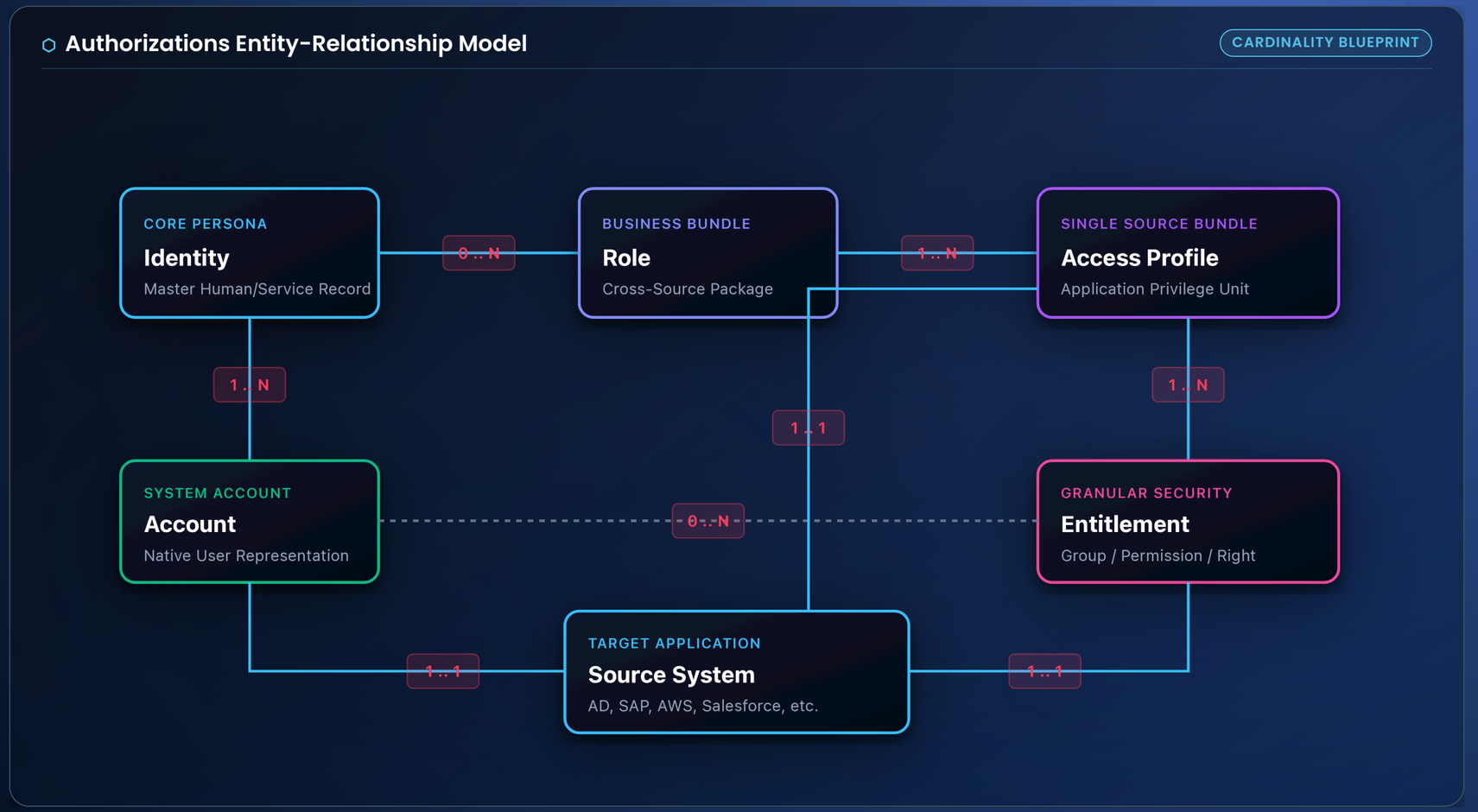
The Authorizations Entity Model

The definitive relationship and cardinality contract governing IdentityNow components

STRUCTURAL RULES

Cardinality Contract (Baseline Slide 35)

1 Identity has 0..N Roles. 1 Role bundles 1..N Access Profiles. 1 Access Profile contains 1..N Entitlements. 1 Access Profile binds strictly to 1 Source. 1 Identity correlates to 1..N Accounts. 1 Account holds 0..N Entitlements. 1 Account resides on 1 Source.



SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Building Blocks: End-to-End System Blueprint

Unified architectural flow integrating Authoritative Sources, Identity Profiles, and Target Systems

SOURCE TO IDENTITY

Authoritative Layer

Authoritative HR source feeds Identity Profiles to generate and update Central Identities, driving dynamic Joiner-Mover-Leaver lifecycle triggers.

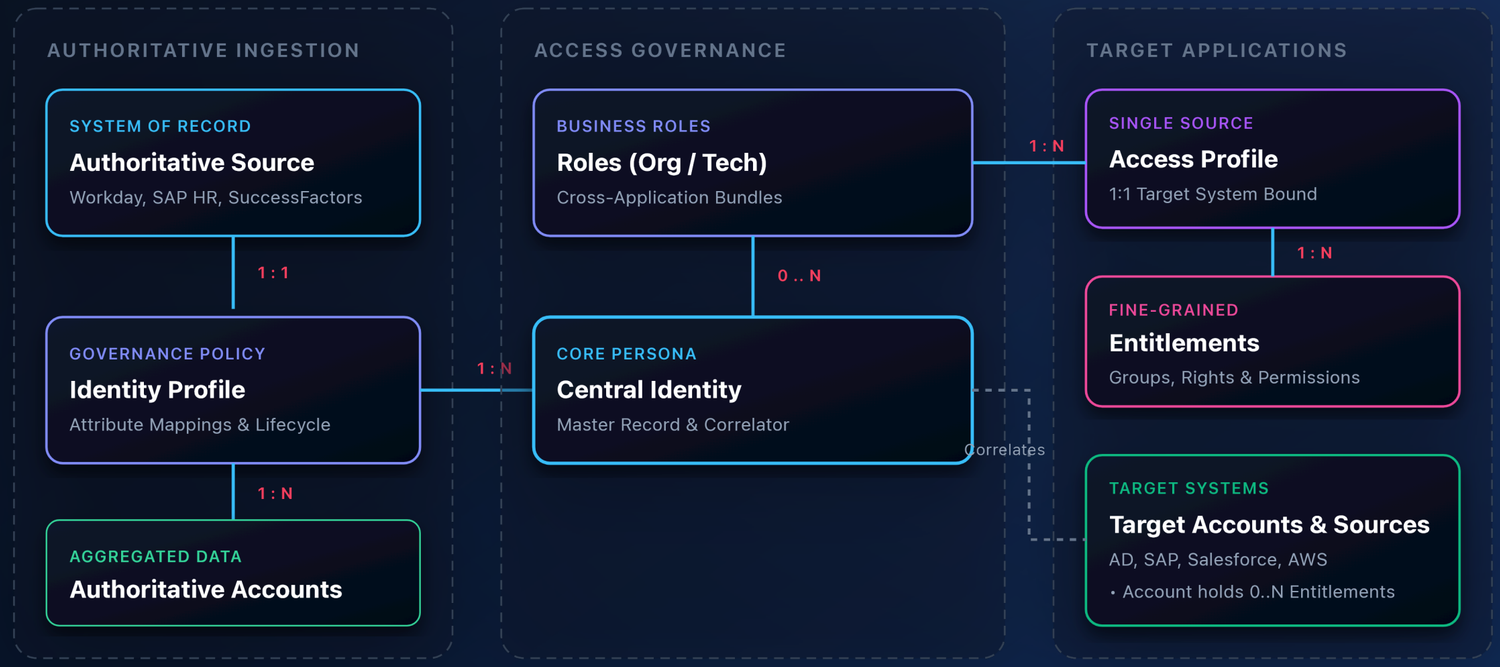
GOVERNANCE TO TARGET

Target & Access Layer

Roles bundle single-source Access Profiles, which encapsulate fine-grained Entitlements residing on target application accounts.

End-to-End System Blueprint

ARCHITECTURE LINEAGE



GOVERNANCE BEST PRACTICES

Architectural Governance Principles

Four inviolable design axioms distilled from the IdentityNow access model

IDENTITY INTEGRITY

Single Authoritative Source Rule

Every identity must originate from exactly one authoritative source profile. Multiple sources feeding a single identity causes split-brain conflicts and corrupts lifecycle governance.

BOUNDARY DISCIPLINE

Single-Source Access Profile Rule

An Access Profile must NEVER span multiple source systems. Keep profiles tightly bound to a single application; use Roles to bundle cross-system permissions.

AUDITABILITY

Role-Centric Access Governance

Direct assignment of atomic entitlements creates governance blindspots. Grant access through audited business roles or monitored requestable roles to ensure audit compliance.

ZERO DRIFT

Continuous Reconciliation & Detection

Leverage automated Access Profile detection to expose out-of-band administrative grants on target systems and maintain continuous compliance between aggregation cycles.